

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Political-geography vocabulary rail

BOUNDARY -> recognised line separating territory or jurisdiction of two states

FRONTIER -> wider zone of transition where authority thins out

BORDERLAND -> lived human-use space on either side of the line

ENCLAVE -> territory entirely enclosed by another state's territory

EXCLAVE -> detached part of a state separated by another state's territory

MUST REMEMBER: Indian political geography connects territorial evolution, international boundaries, maritime zones, federal units, borderland societies and neighbourhood corridors; boundary morphology must distinguish natural, geometric, antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relic forms without treating labels as complete histories.

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## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Four stages of boundary making

ALLOCATION -> political decision on who receives which territory

DELIMITATION -> the line is drawn in map and text form

DEMARCATIION -> pillars, fences, coordinates or a channel reference on the ground

ADMINISTRATION -> check posts, patrols, crossings and settlement management

WEAK POINTS -> a paper line never marked, and a defining feature that later moves

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Boundary classification matrix

PHYSICAL FORM -> natural follows mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea

PHYSICAL FORM -> geometric follows a straight or coordinate-based line

GENESIS -> antecedent drawn before dense settlement; subsequent adjusted to it

GENESIS -> superimposed cuts across existing fabric; relict survives in landscape

RULE -> genesis predicts dispute type; neither form is intrinsically stable

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Dispute-cause typology

IF the parties agree on ownership but not alignment -> positional dispute

IF the parties contest ownership of a named area -> territorial dispute

IF the line is agreed but use across it is contested -> resource or functional dispute

IF the line predates or cuts across settlement -> antecedent or superimposed problem

IF the defining river or watershed moves -> geomorphic instability recalculates the line

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Frontier to boundary conversion

HISTORICAL FRONTIER -> broad transition zone administered with tolerated ambiguity

STATE CONSOLIDATION -> a precise line becomes legally and militarily necessary

CONVERSION -> ambiguity must be resolved into one agreed alignment

FRICTION -> competing readings of the same terrain surface as claims

LESSON -> many disputes begin at the moment a zone is asked to become a line

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Classical lenses and their omissions

HEARTLAND -> interior continental depth and overland access as the variable

RIMLAND -> coastal transition belts around the Eurasian margin

SEA POWER -> naval access, ports and sea lines of communication

OMISSIONS -> air and space power, cyber and submarine cables, interdependence

OMISSIONS -> non-state actors and nuclear deterrence; geography conditions, not determines

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: India's dual strategic character

CONTINENTAL SIDE -> mountain and plains frontier requiring land force and infrastructure

MARITIME SIDE -> peninsular position astride major sea lanes with island territories

CONSEQUENCE -> a genuine resource trade-off between the two theatres

ANSWER MOVE -> recognise duality instead of assigning India to one school

CAUTION -> avoid quoting boundary lengths or disputed areas from memory

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Sector-by-terrain management framework

HIGH-ALTITUDE GLACIATED -> inaccessibility, watershed ambiguity, costly infrastructure  
DENSELY POPULATED PLAINS -> fencing feasible but divides fields; smuggling dominates  
RIVERINE AND DELTAIC -> migrating channels, shifting char lands, fencing impossible  
FORESTED HILL -> cross-border ethnic continuity and traditional movement regimes  
DESERT AND MARITIME -> long-distance surveillance; zone delimitation and fishing friction



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Differentiated border management fork

SECTOR IDENTIFIED -> state terrain, settlement density and legal status of the line  
IF terrain and settlement differ across sectors -> uniform instruments will misfit  
IF hardening ignores local livelihoods -> alienation grows in the borderland  
THEREFORE -> combine infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration  
AND -> keep force doctrine outside a geography answer; retain terrain-to-management logic

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: India neighbour adjacency grid

LAND NEIGHBOURS -> Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar

CLAIMED ADJACENCY -> Afghanistan through India's far north-west map position

MARITIME NEIGHBOURS -> Sri Lanka across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar

MARITIME NEIGHBOURS -> Maldives across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep

LAND BRIDGE -> Myanmar alone opens India into mainland South-East Asia

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Line of Control, Line of Actual Control, International Boundary and Actual Ground Position Line are not interchangeable; Radcliffe, McMahon and Durand lines have different origins/statuses, a land boundary differs from a maritime delimitation, and border management from final boundary settlement.

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## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Boundary-line category firewall

RADCLIFFE LINE 1947 -> partition framework for the boundary with Pakistan

McMAHON LINE 1914 FRAMEWORK -> eastern-sector India-China boundary claim

DURAND LINE 1893 -> Afghanistan-Pakistan line, never an India-Pakistan line

CEASEFIRE LINE 1949 TO LINE OF CONTROL 1972 -> military control, not sovereignty

LINE OF ACTUAL CONTROL -> control reality over an undemarcated mountain frontier

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar sectors plus Sri

Lanka/Maldives maritime neighbourhood require pass-river-valley-corridor logic; Sir Creek, Siachen, Doklam, Kalapani-Lipulekh, Teesta, enclaves and connectivity projects need exact bilateral/legal and current-status qualification.

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## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Sectors, settlement chain and mandates

WESTERN SECTOR -> Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space with watershed ambiguity

MIDDLE AND EASTERN SECTORS -> Himachal and Uttarakhand; Sikkim and Arunachal

LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT -> 1974 accord, 2011 Protocol, 2015 implementation

SETTLEMENT EFFECT -> enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches resolved

MANDATES -> BSF, ITBP, SSB, Assam Rifles and Coast Guard mapped to terrain